

Accessible Digital Textbooks · ADT Studio

Kids Mode

UNICEF | **Ceibal**

UX Feature Report · July 2026

Buddy-guided reading
for ages 4–8

Summary

A friendly reading companion for the youngest readers.

Kids Mode turns any accessible digital textbook into a warm, guided experience for early readers. A hand-picked **reading buddy** welcomes the child by name, explains the tools in plain language, reads the book aloud, and cheers them on through every quiz. Children design **their own avatar**, and the whole interface — text, buddy voice, and celebrations — speaks **their language**.

9-step

playful, narrated
onboarding

5

reading buddies,
each fully voiced

100%

offline — no
accounts, no
tracking

The experience

Three moments, one companion



Get ready

The child meets their buddy, picks how they want to read, types their name and builds their own character.



Read together

The buddy reads aloud, offers help on tap, adjusts comfort, switches language, and quietly cheers the reader on.

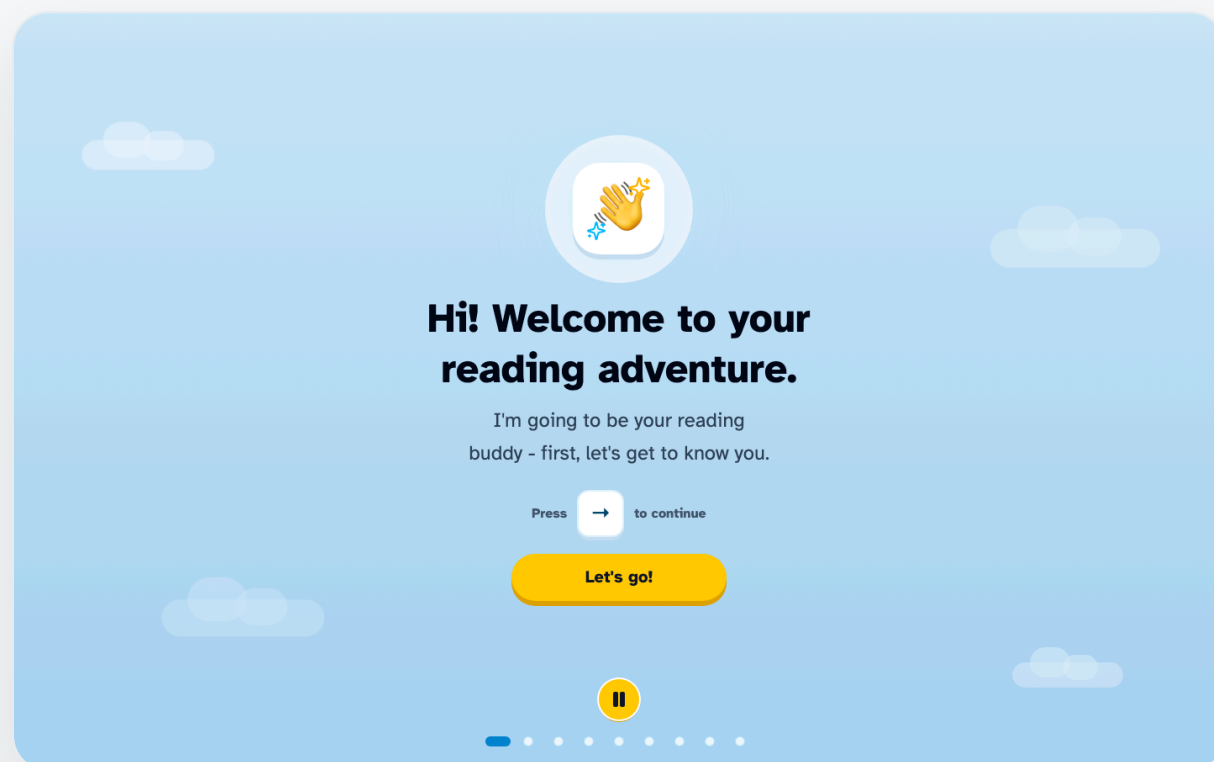


Celebrate

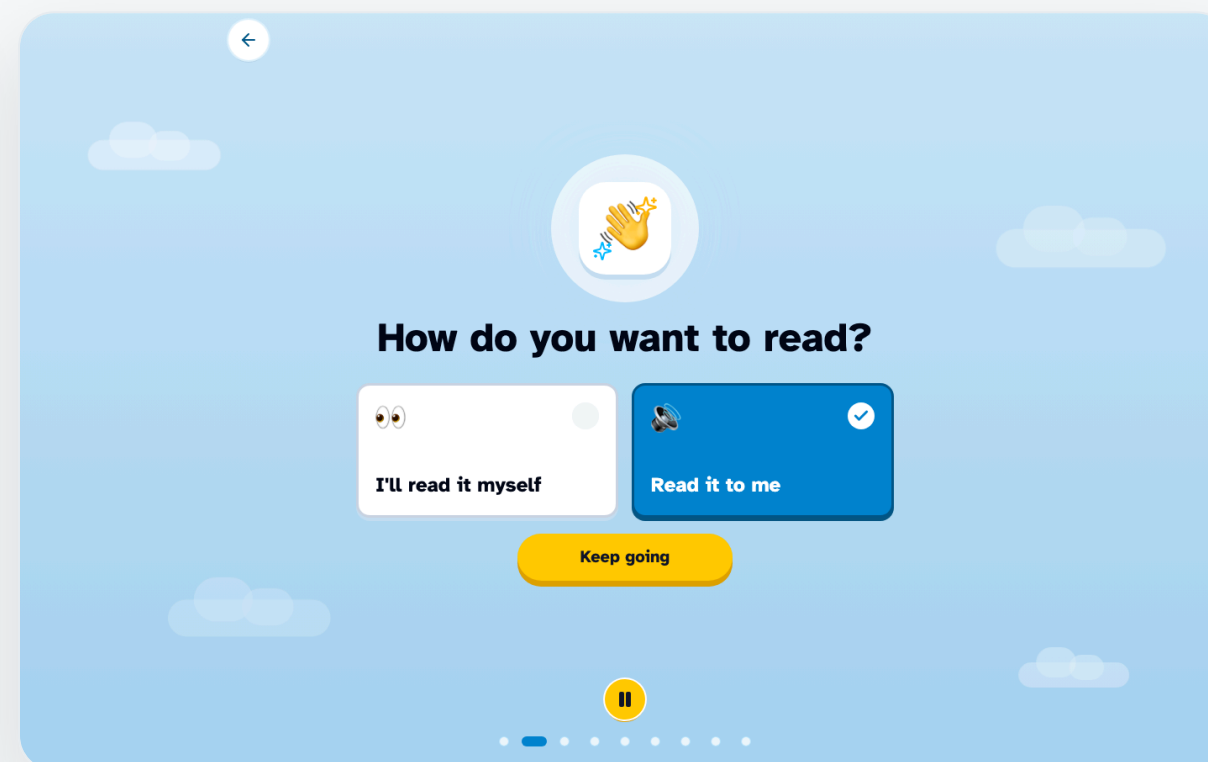
Every correct answer earns a spoken reaction, and finishing the book brings a personal celebration screen.

A gentle, narrated welcome

Every step is read out loud by default, with a big pause button and progress dots. The child first chooses whether to read alone or be read to.



Warm welcome — narrated, with a pause control

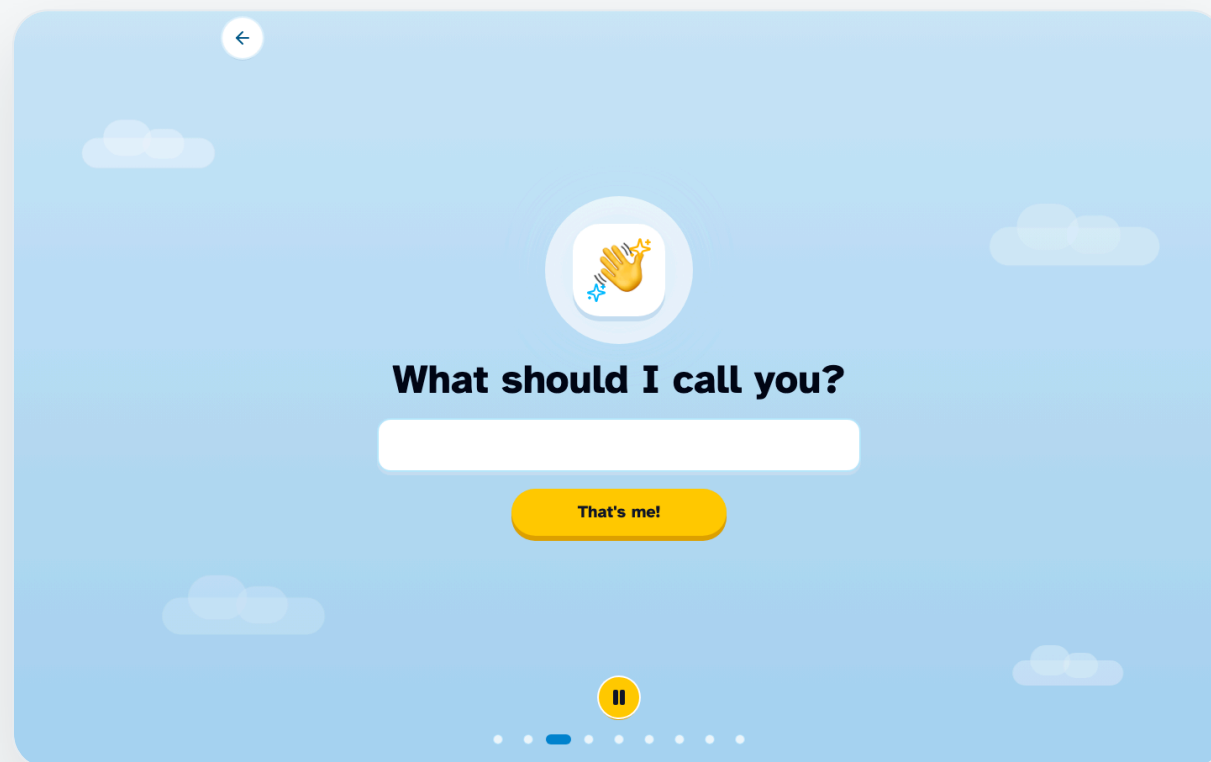


"Read to me" or "I'll read it myself"

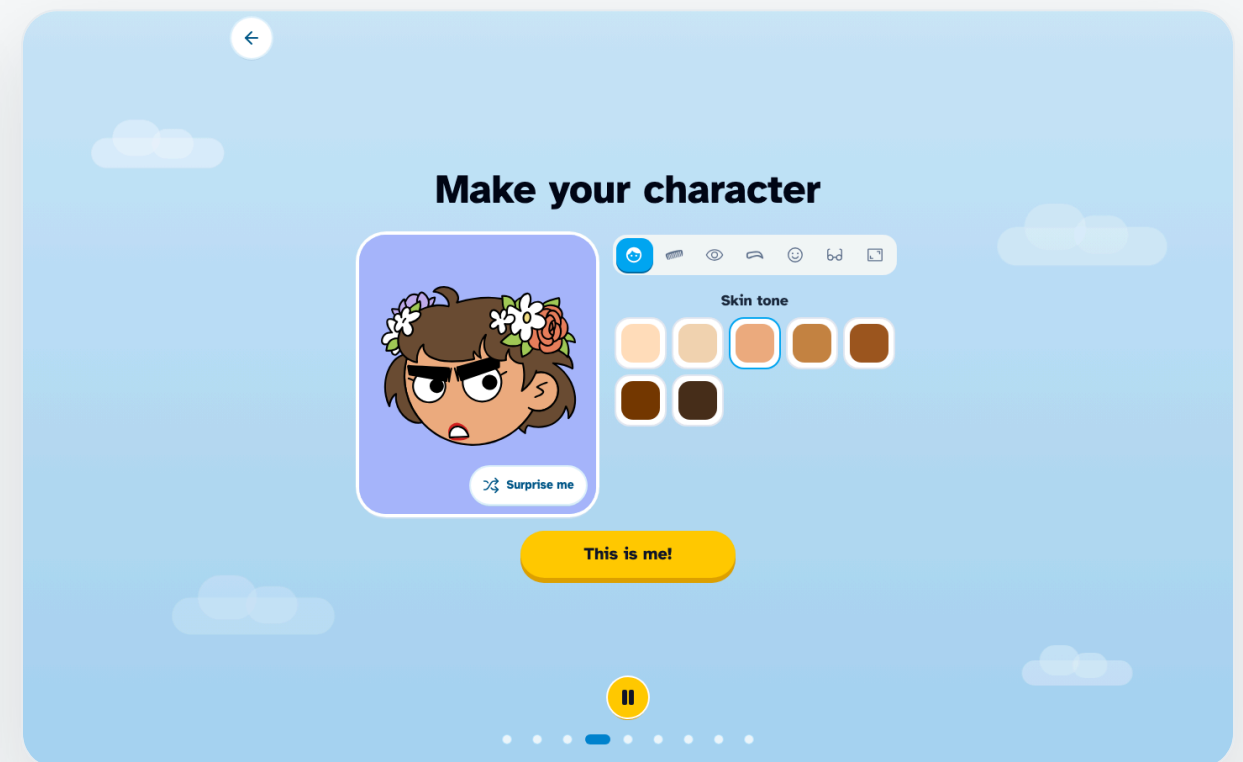
Onboarding

Make it personal

The child tells the buddy their name, then designs a character that represents them — carried through the whole experience.



"What should I call you?"



"Make your character"

Avatar builder

Design yourself

A character just for them

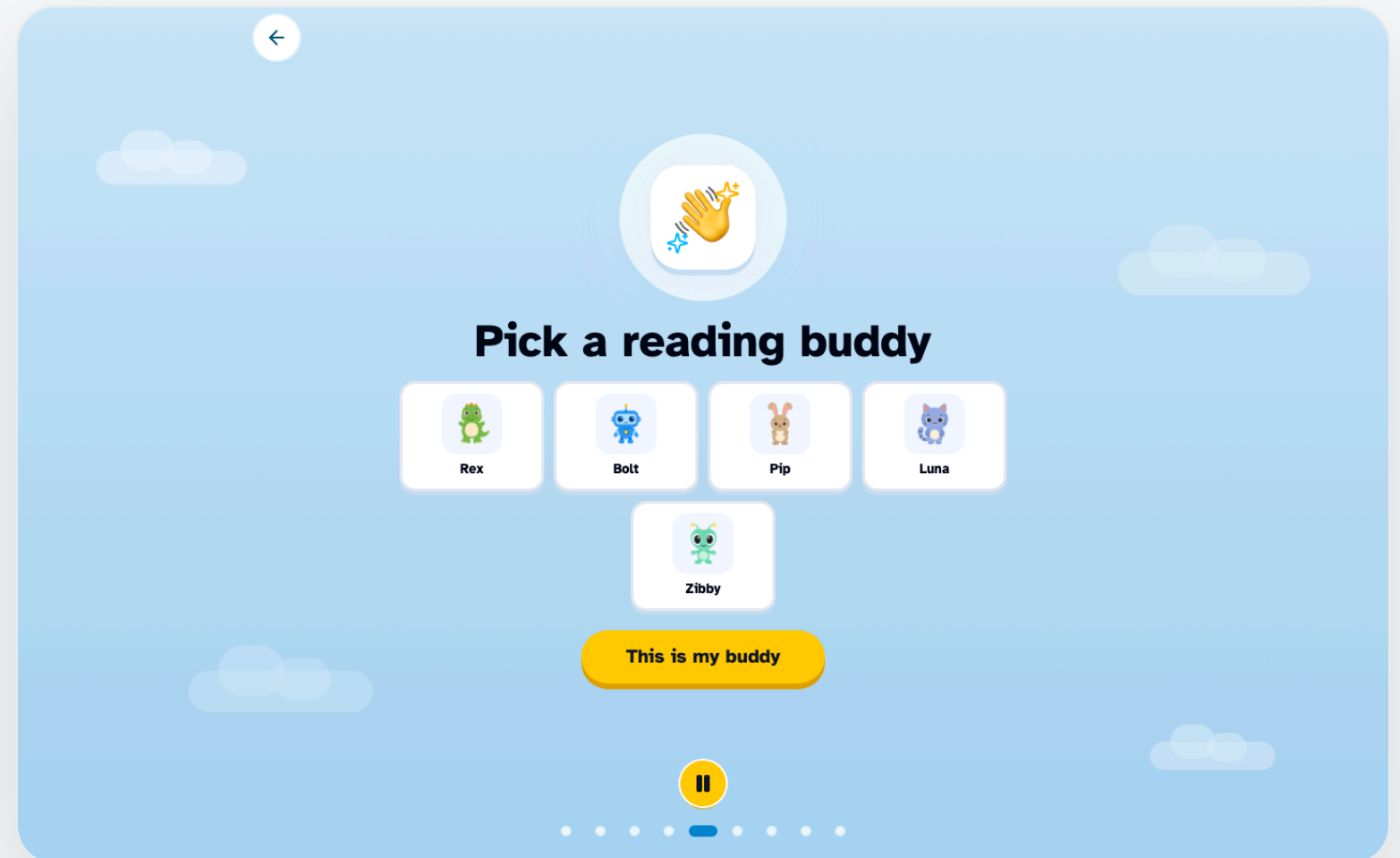
- ✓ Big **portrait preview** beside a two-pane editor — modelled on familiar, kid-loved builders
- ✓ **Icon tabs** with a sliding indicator; skin, hair, eyes, mouth, accessories & background
- ✓ **Large option cards** sized for low-vision readers, colours first
- ✓ Fully **offline** illustrated art — no network, editable any time from the buddy menu

Your buddy

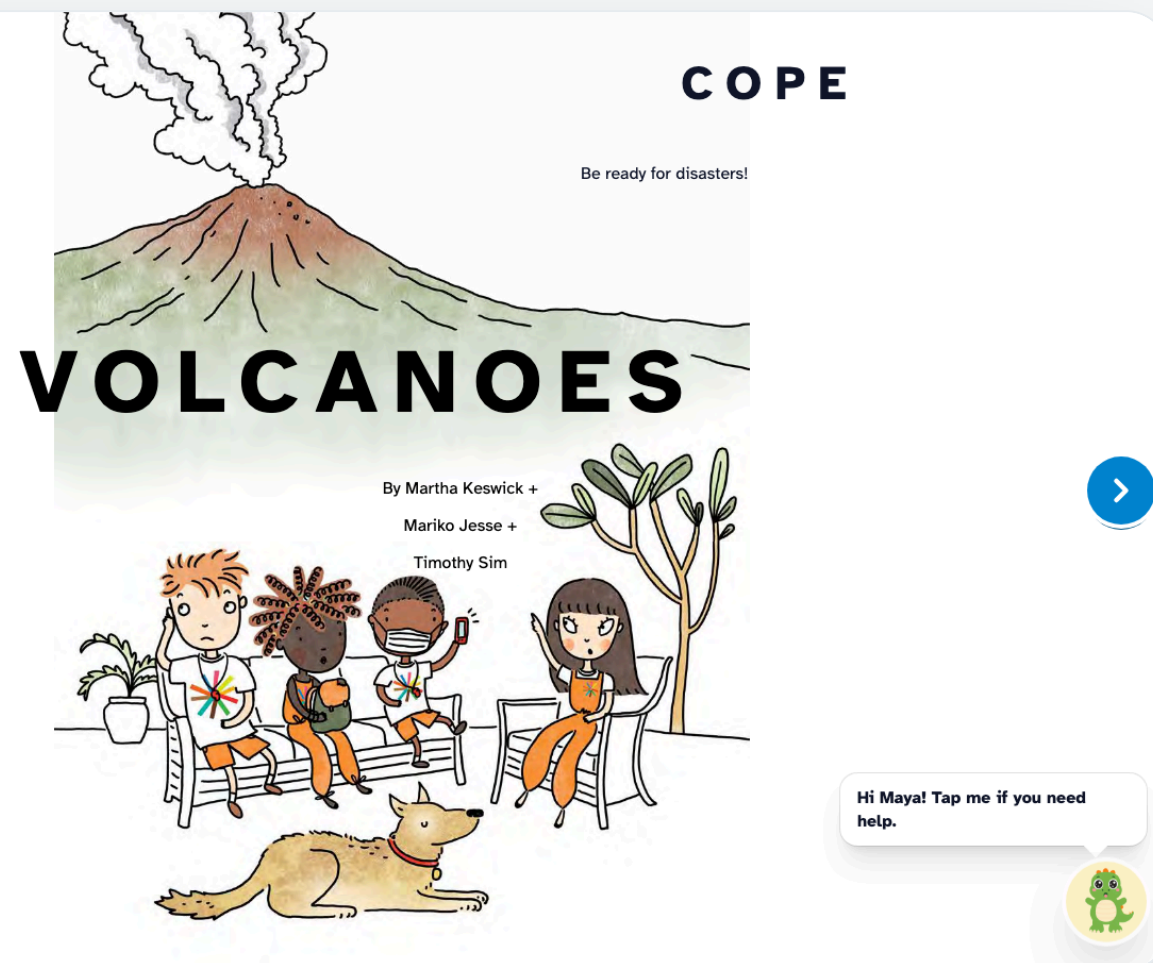
Pick a reading buddy

Five friends, real voices

- ✓ Dino, Robot, Bunny, Cat & Alien — each with its **own personality & voice**
- ✓ The buddy greets the child **by name** and stays with them throughout
- ✓ Playful, character-specific lines (“Rawr! I’m Rex!”) baked per language



Guided reading



On the page

Always there to help

- ✓ Big, friendly **page arrows** and a floating buddy that speaks up when needed
- ✓ The buddy offers a **“tap me if you need help”** prompt, personalised by name
- ✓ Gentle idle encouragement keeps the reader company without distracting

One tap away

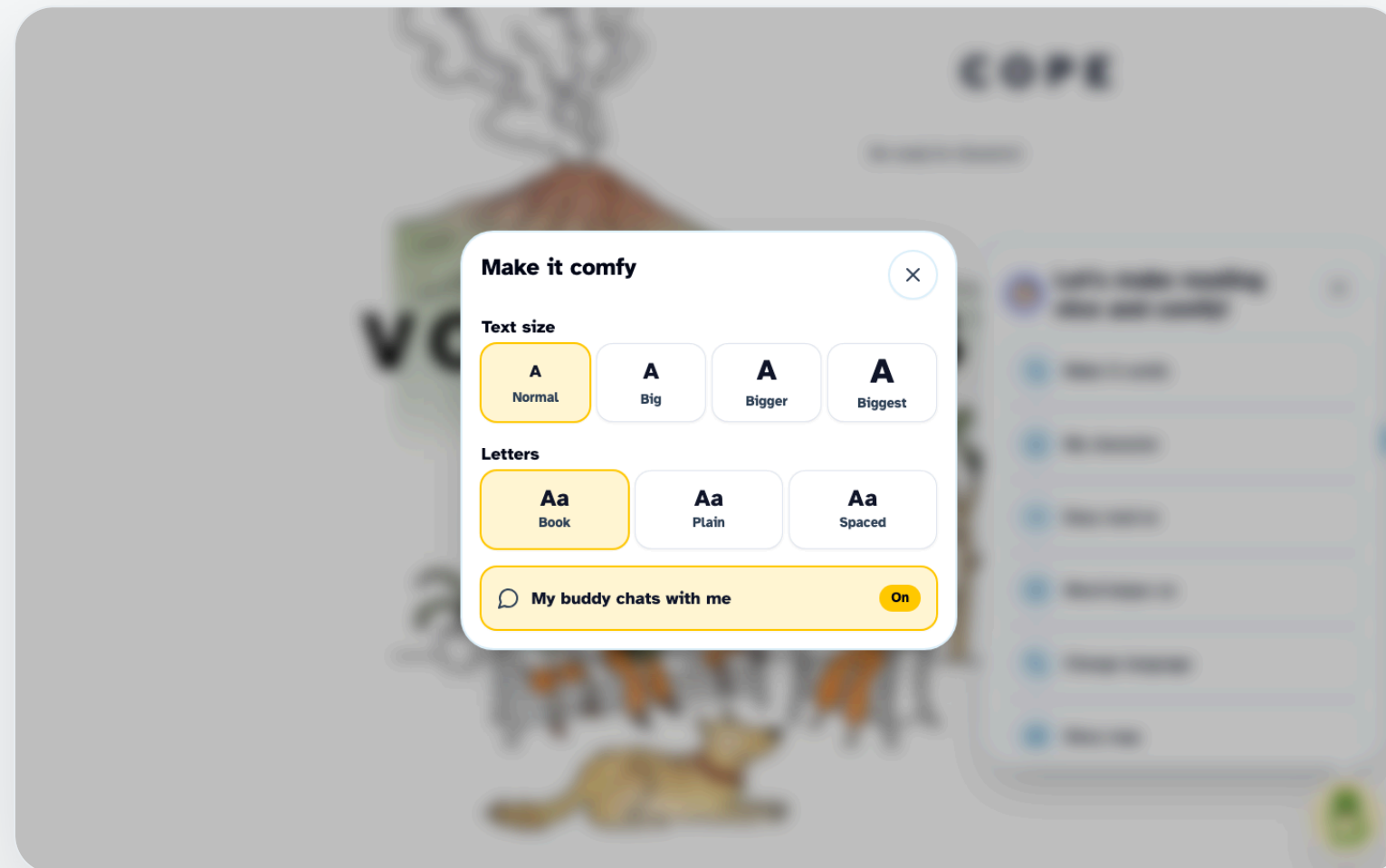
The buddy menu

Every tool, in kid words

- ✓ **Read to me** · reading speed · **Make it comfy**
- ✓ **My character** · Easy read · Word helper · Explain simply
- ✓ **Change language** · Story map · notes — all renamed for children



Accessibility



Make it comfy

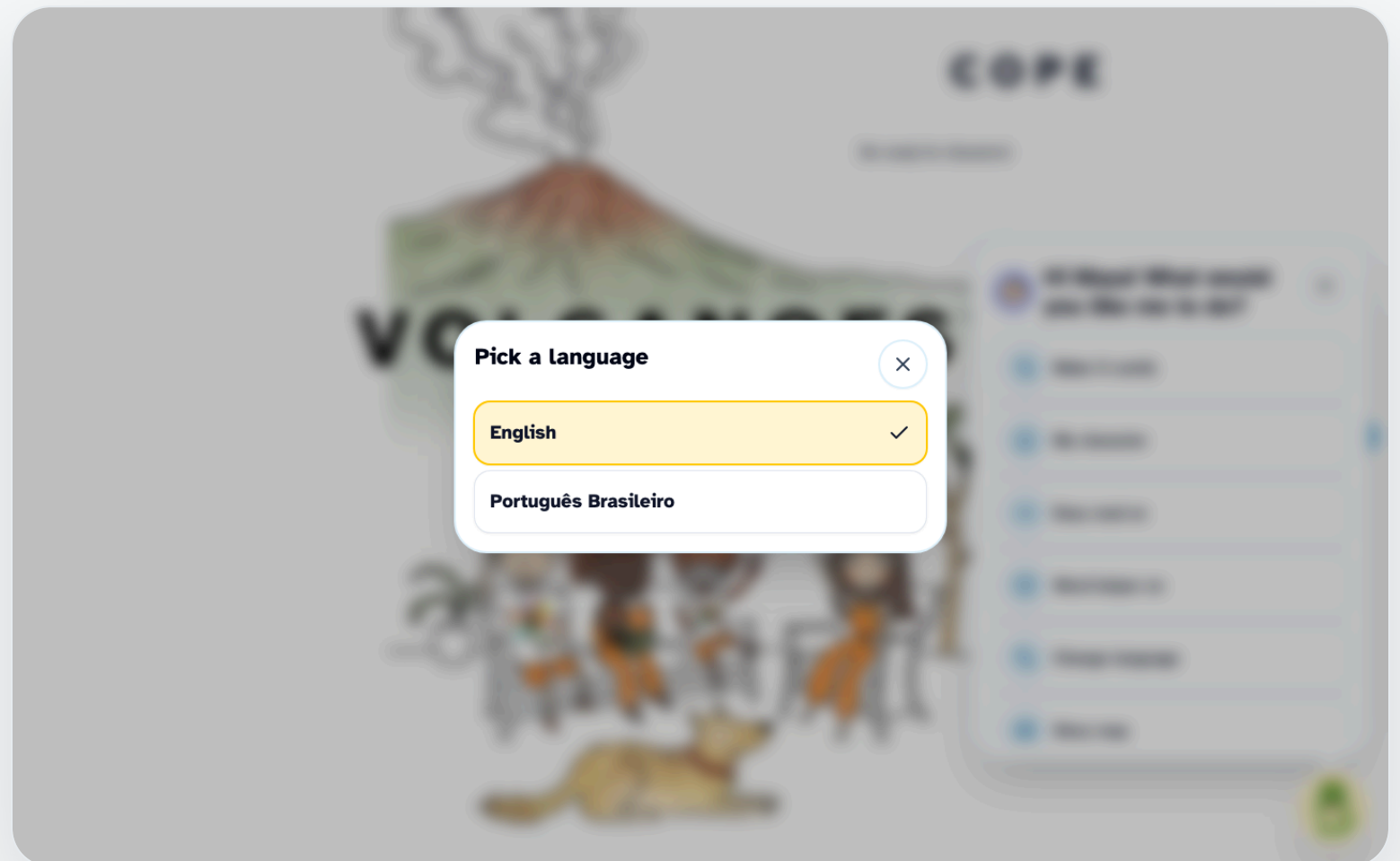
Comfort, the child's way

- ✓ **Text size** (Normal → Biggest) applied live to the book
- ✓ **Letter spacing** & a dyslexia-friendly reading font
- ✓ Turn **buddy chatter** on/off; honours reduced-motion
- ✓ Built on top of the existing read-aloud, easy-read & glossary tools

Language

The whole world moves together

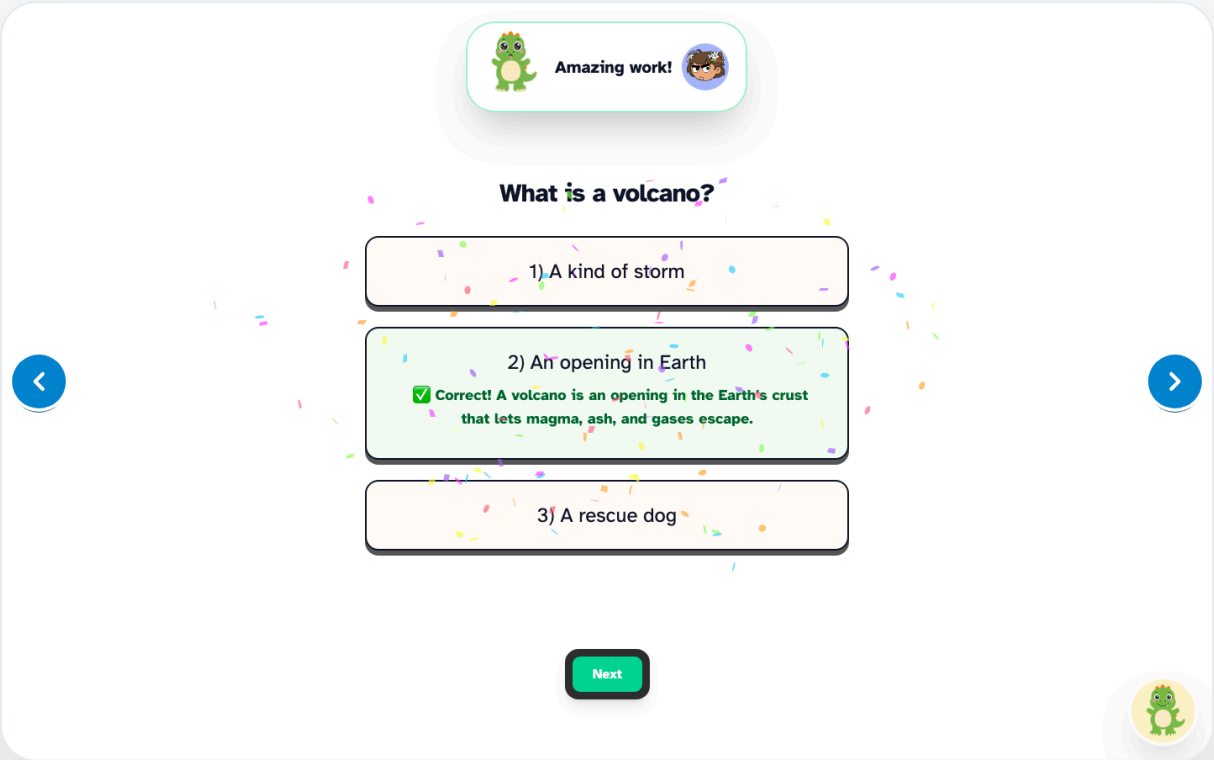
- ✓ Switching language moves the **book text, the buddy interface, and the spoken voice** at once
- ✓ A language is offered when the **book** or the **kids interface** is translated
- ✓ Buddy & narrator clips are **baked from the translated text**, never mismatched



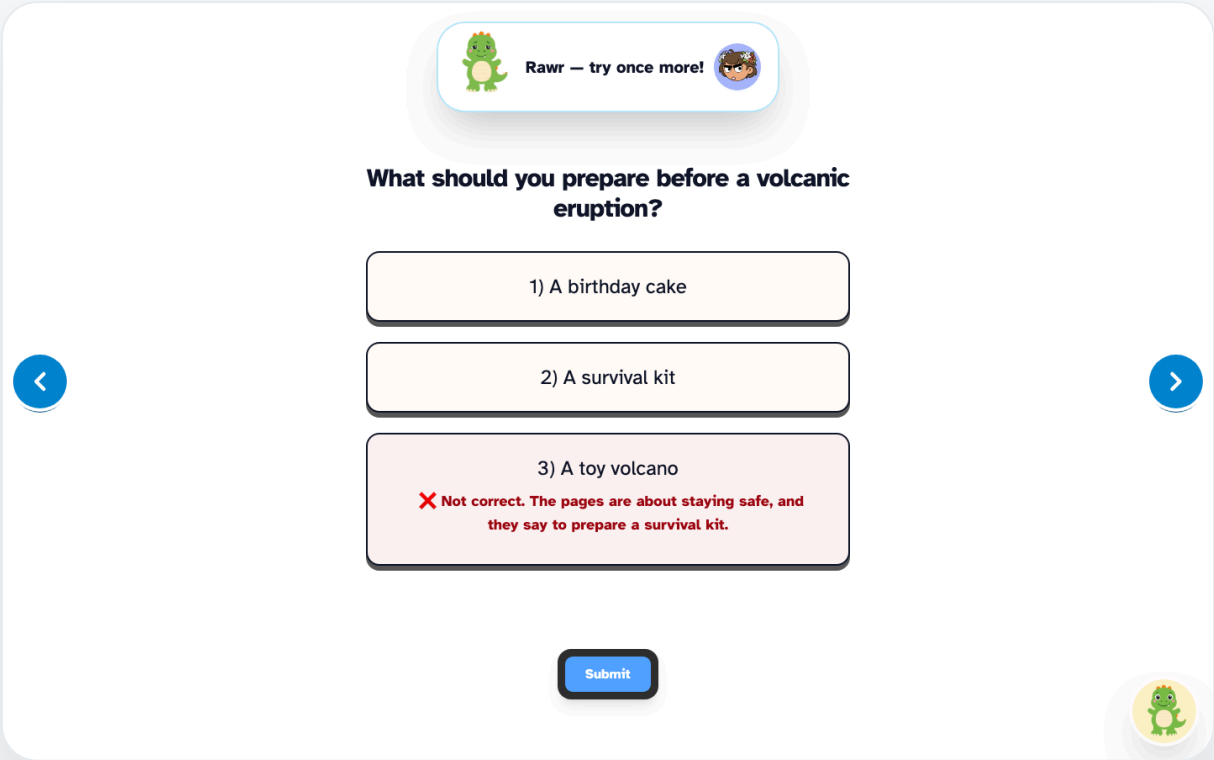
Encouragement

The buddy reacts to every answer

Across quizzes and every activity type, the buddy appears next to the child’s own avatar with a spoken line — celebrating a win, or gently encouraging another try.

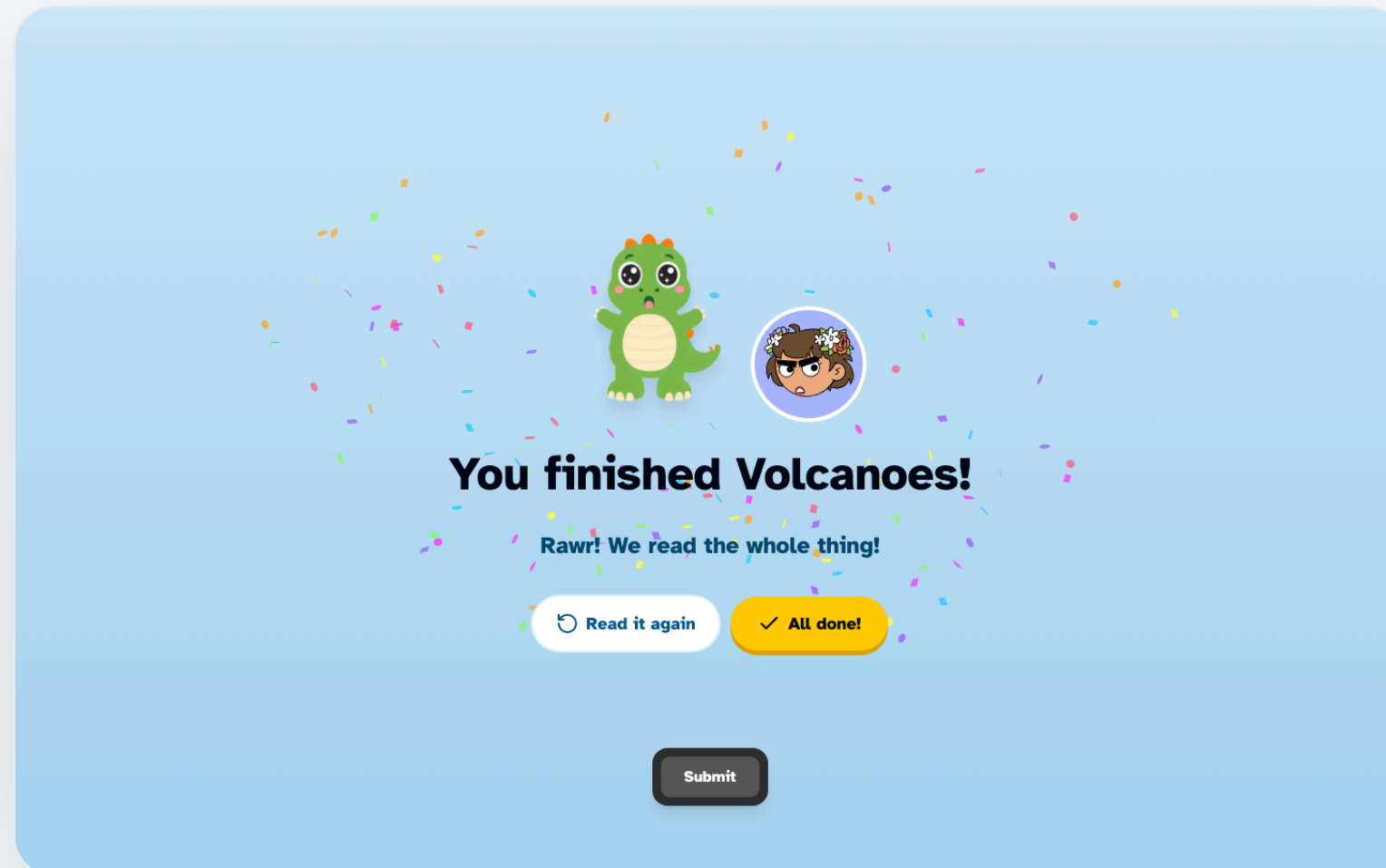


Correct → “Amazing work!” with confetti



Incorrect → “Good try! Give it another go.”

The big finish



Finishing the book

A moment worth earning

- ✓ The last page turns the arrow into a **“finish” celebration** button
- ✓ Buddy + avatar, confetti, and a spoken line that names **the child** and **the book**
- ✓ **Read it again** or **All done** — the child stays in control

Under the hood

Built to ship inside the book



Fully offline

Avatar art and buddy voice packs are packaged into the book — no accounts, no network, no tracking.



Per-book voices

Buddy & narrator clips are generated per language from a single line registry, cached globally, and baked from translated text.



One source of truth

Lines, buddies and avatar parts live in a shared package, so Studio and the runtime can never drift.

What's shipped

- ✓ Narrated 9-step onboarding with read-mode choice
- ✓ Five voiced buddies + name personalisation
- ✓ Offline avatar builder (onboarding + editable later)
- ✓ Buddy menu wrapping all reading tools in kid language
- ✓ Comfort & accessibility (size, spacing, font, chatter)
- ✓ Language switch moving book + UI + voices together
- ✓ Voiced buddy reactions in all activities & quizzes
- ✓ Book-specific end-of-book celebration screen

Roadmap

Next steps



Dark / low-light mode

A calm, low-glare theme across the entire kids experience for evening and light-sensitive reading.



Custom buddy library

Let teams upload their own illustrated buddies once in Studio and reuse them across every book.



Deaf & HOH support

A dedicated co-designed line of work — sign-language buddy guidance and visual-first reactions.



Book-aware voice lines

Optionally bake the book title into the spoken celebration for an even more personal finish.



More languages, faster

One-tap translate-and-voice for every locale the catalogue already supports.



Classroom testing

Field-test with 5–8 year-olds and iterate on wording, pacing and reward cadence.

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Reading, together.

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